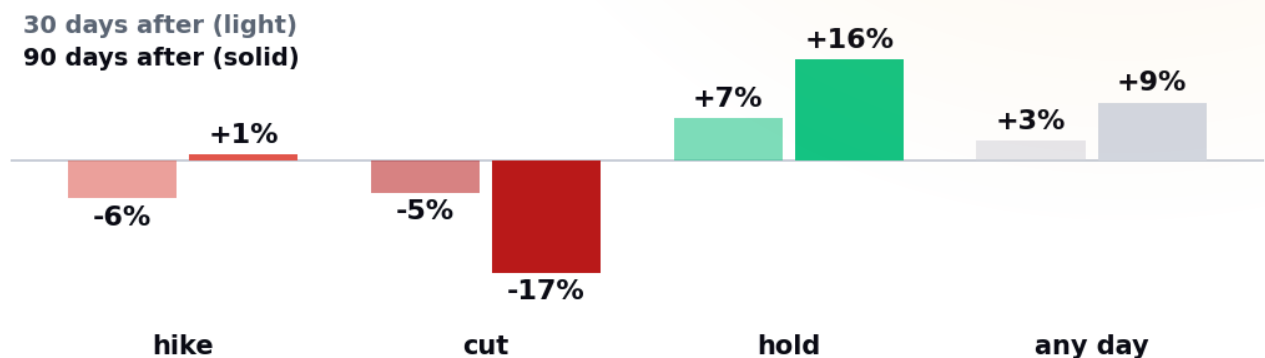


THE FED DECISION STUDY

Every scheduled Federal Reserve decision since 2015, 92 of them, graded against Bitcoin. The run-up into the meeting, then 7, 30, 60 and 90 days after, hikes, cuts and holds, against any random day.

The month after a hike, the cut that was worse than the hike, the hold that beat everything, and this week's decision by the base rates.



median Bitcoin return after every Fed decision since 2015. 20 hikes, 9 cuts, 63 holds, against any day.

3 of 20

hikes followed by a higher price 30 days later

2 of 9

cuts followed by a higher price 60 days later

66%

of holds higher 90 days later

Educational, not financial advice. The calendar and the outcomes come from public records, the base rate sits next to every figure, and twenty hikes and nine cuts are small samples and are treated as such.



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THE TEST

HOW EVERY DECISION WAS GRADED

The Federal Open Market Committee meets eight times a year and announces its decision on a Wednesday afternoon, occasionally a Thursday. Each scheduled decision since January 2015 is one event. The outcome, hike, cut or hold, comes from the change in the Fed funds upper target as published by the St. Louis Fed, which dates changes the day after the announcement, so each meeting is matched to the change that lands within three days of it.

For every decision, Bitcoin's close 7 days before the meeting to the decision-day close is the run-up. Then the decision-day close to the close 7, 30, 60 and 90 days later. Bitstamp daily closes throughout. The base rate is the same window measured from every single day since 2015, so a Fed-day number only means something if it differs from that.

One event is deliberately not in the count. The emergency 100 basis point cut on 16 March 2020 fell on an unscheduled Sunday and is left out, because the study is about the scheduled decisions traders position for. It would have made the cut bucket look worse, not better.

THE COUNT

20 hikes, 9 cuts, 63 holds. Same ruler for all 92, then the three outcomes get separated.

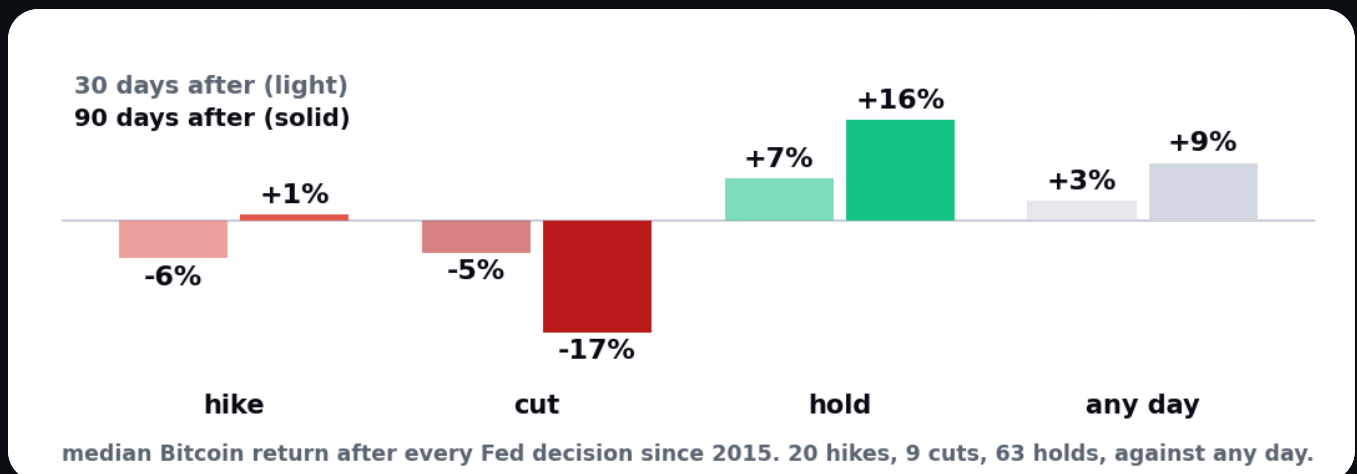
THE SCOREBOARD

HIKES, CUTS AND HOLDS AGAINST ANY DAY

OUTCOME	N	RUN-UP 7D	+7D	+30D, UP	+60D, UP	+90D, UP
hikes	20	+1.4%	-0.6%	-6.0% / 15%	-3.2% / 40%	+0.9% / 50%
cuts	9	+2.3%	-0.8%	-5.0% / 33%	-19.1% / 22%	-17.4% / 33%
holds	63	+1.5%	+0.3%	+6.5% / 63%	+10.1% / 66%	+15.6% / 66%
any day	4,244	+0.7%	+0.7%	+3.1% / 58%	+7.2% / 58%	+8.9% / 60%

Medians. 'up' = share of cases with a higher close. Any day = every day since 2015.

The run-up is real and small. Into a decision Bitcoin rose a median +1.9%, higher 61% of the time, against +0.7% for any week. The week after a decision, +0.2%, is noise. The month after is where the three outcomes come apart, and they come apart in a way the popular script gets backwards. The hike hurts for a month. The cut hurts for a quarter. The hold, the outcome nobody tweets about, beats a random day at every horizon.



HIKES

ALL 20 HIKES, AND THE MONTH AFTER

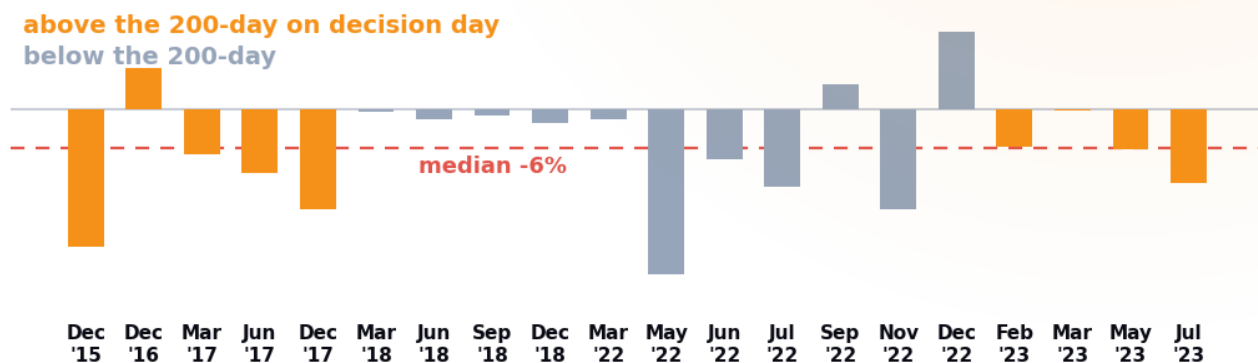
DECISION	SIZE	TREND	RUN-UP 7D	+7D	+30D	+60D	+90D
16 Dec 2015	25 bp	above	+9%	-3%	-21%	-11%	-9%
14 Dec 2016	25 bp	above	+2%	+7%	+6%	+29%	+60%
15 Mar 2017	25 bp	above	+9%	-17%	-7%	+42%	+115%
14 Jun 2017	25 bp	above	-9%	+8%	-10%	+65%	+70%
13 Dec 2017	25 bp	above	+19%	+1%	-15%	-50%	-44%
21 Mar 2018	25 bp	below	+9%	-11%	-0%	-4%	-24%
13 Jun 2018	25 bp	below	-18%	+7%	-1%	+0%	-0%
26 Sep 2018	25 bp	below	+1%	-0%	-1%	-39%	-41%
19 Dec 2018	25 bp	below	+7%	+3%	-2%	-2%	+9%
16 Mar 2022	25 bp	below	-2%	+4%	-1%	-24%	-46%
04 May 2022	50 bp	below	+1%	-27%	-25%	-51%	-42%
15 Jun 2022	75 bp	below	-25%	-11%	-8%	+8%	-11%
27 Jul 2022	75 bp	below	-1%	-1%	-12%	-18%	-13%
21 Sep 2022	75 bp	below	-9%	+5%	+4%	-12%	-8%
02 Nov 2022	75 bp	below	-3%	-21%	-15%	-18%	+15%
14 Dec 2022	50 bp	below	+6%	-5%	+12%	+22%	+39%
01 Feb 2023	25 bp	above	+3%	-3%	-6%	+19%	+21%
22 Mar 2023	25 bp	above	+12%	+4%	-0%	-2%	+4%
03 May 2023	25 bp	above	+2%	-5%	-6%	+5%	+2%
26 Jul 2023	25 bp	above	-2%	-1%	-11%	-11%	+16%

Trend = Bitcoin above or below its 200-day average on the decision day.

HIKES

THE MONTH AFTER A HIKE, AND THE TREND

Thirty days after a hike, Bitcoin was lower by a median 6%, and higher only 3 times in 20. That is the cleanest single number in the study. Ninety days out the picture splits by trend. Above the 200-day average the dip recovered, a median of +16% with 7 of 9 higher. Below it, -11% with 3 of 11 higher. A hike costs the month either way. Whether the month comes back depends on the trend the hike landed in, not on the hike.



Bitcoin 30 days after every Fed hike since 2015. Higher in 3 of 20.

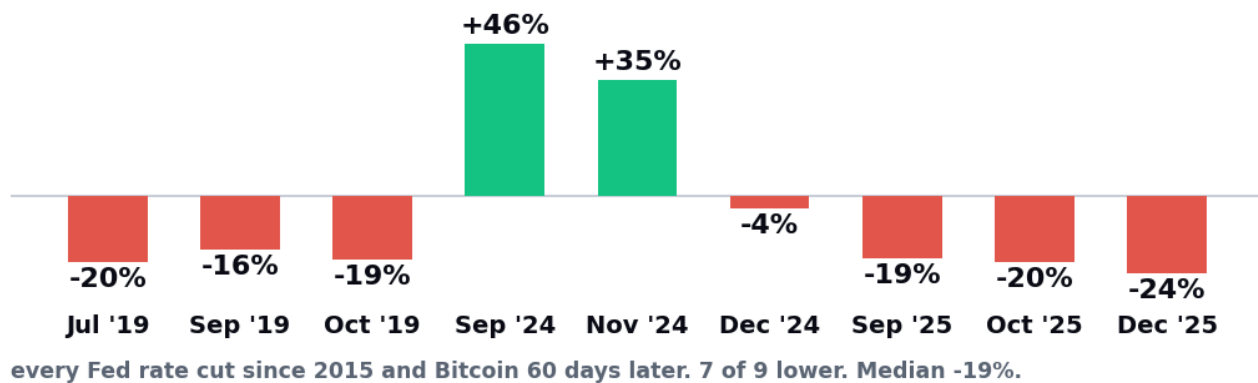
CUTS

ALL 9 CUTS, THE BULLISH ONE

DECISION	SIZE	TREND	RUN-UP 7D	+7D	+30D	+60D	+90D
31 Jul 2019	25 bp	above	+3%	+19%	-5%	-20%	-7%
18 Sep 2019	25 bp	above	-0%	-17%	-22%	-16%	-35%
30 Oct 2019	25 bp	above	+23%	+2%	-15%	-19%	+3%
18 Sep 2024	50 bp	below	+8%	+2%	+11%	+46%	+72%
07 Nov 2024	25 bp	above	+8%	+15%	+32%	+35%	+27%
18 Dec 2024	25 bp	above	-1%	-1%	+4%	-4%	-17%
17 Sep 2025	25 bp	above	+2%	-3%	-9%	-19%	-25%
29 Oct 2025	25 bp	above	+2%	-6%	-17%	-20%	-19%
10 Dec 2025	25 bp	below	-2%	-6%	-2%	-24%	-24%

The 2020 emergency cut is excluded as unscheduled.

Thirty days after a cut, a median -5%, higher 3 of 9. Sixty days, -19%, higher 2 of 9. Ninety days, -17%, higher 3 of 9. The three 2019 cuts led into the 2019 to 2020 slide. The three late-2025 cuts all led to a price 19 to 24% lower within 90 days. The one clean exception is September 2024, the half-point cut that preceded the election rally. A cut is what the Fed does when it sees damage the market has not priced. It is the diagnosis, not the medicine.



HOLDS, AND THE TREND

THE BORING OUTCOME, AND THE REGIME TABLE

63 of the 92 decisions changed nothing. Thirty days later Bitcoin was higher a median +6.5%, up 63% of the time. Ninety days later +15.6%, up 66%. Both beat any random day. A hold means nothing broke and nothing tightened, which is the only Fed setting Bitcoin has ever consistently liked.

OUTCOME AND TREND	N	+30D MEDIAN	+30D HIGHER	+90D MEDIAN	+90D HIGHER
hike, above the 200-day	9	-6.9%	1 of 9	+15.5%	7 of 9
hike, below the 200-day	11	-1.5%	2 of 11	-10.5%	3 of 11
cut, above the 200-day	7	-8.6%	2 of 7	-17.4%	2 of 7
cut, below the 200-day	2	+4.6%	1 of 2	+24.0%	1 of 2
hold, above the 200-day	42	+5.8%	27 of 42	+19.4%	30 of 42
hold, below the 200-day	21	+7.1%	13 of 21	+6.5%	11 of 20

Above or below the 200-day average on the decision day. Two cuts below the 200-day is two cuts, read it that way.

The regime column is the honest complication. Hikes in an uptrend recovered, hikes in a downtrend did not. Cuts in an uptrend were the worst cell on the whole board, because those cuts were the Fed reacting to a slowdown while the crowd was still bullish. Holds were fine in both. If you take one rule from the table, it is that the trend on the decision day told you more about the next quarter than the decision did.

THIS WEEK

WEDNESDAY, BY THE BASE RATES

The last five decisions, January to July 2026, were holds. Bitcoin is above its 200-day average as of this writing and below the last lower high of the bear at \$82,833, which is the structural definition this page has used all year. As of 14 September the market is pricing a 90% probability of a quarter-point hike to 3.75 to 4.00%, per CME FedWatch, against 10% for a hold.

If the Fed hikes, the base rate for the next month is red in 17 of 20 cases. Which regime bucket it belongs to is arguable, above the 200-day by the simple rule, below the last lower high by structure, and the two buckets disagree at 90 days. If the Fed holds, it is the one outcome in this study that argues against the pullback that every other base rate this month has pointed to. That is printed here because a study that only prints the numbers that help is not a study.

THE TEST

Whatever they do, the day after is noise. Grade the decision a month later, not an hour later. This is a study, not a call.

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

Twenty hikes and nine cuts. Medians on samples that size describe the middle of a wide spread. The hold bucket is the only one large enough to lean on, and even it spans two bull markets and three bears.

The Fed is not the only thing happening. Every decision sits inside a market that would have moved anyway. The base-rate column is there to separate the Fed's day from an ordinary day, and the regime table is there to separate the Fed from the trend. Neither fully does.

Bitcoin has only existed through one full hiking cycle and two easing cycles. 2015 to 2018, 2022 to 2023, and the cuts of 2019, 2024 and 2025. That is the whole record. Treat every figure as a lean, not a law.

Data pinned 14 September 2026. FOMC calendar from the Bitcoin Daily event-study harness; outcomes from FRED series DFEDTARU; prices Bitstamp BTC/USD daily closes. Scripts: FOMC/fomc_study.py, fomc_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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